

You need to restart the system in case any of the kernel modules have been modified. Any binaries which have been affected also need to be restarted.

Using the `FreeBSD-update` command, you can update the generic kernel. In the case of custom kernel installation, it needs to be reinstalled after finishing the installation of `FreeBSD-update`. To verify installation, you need to use the `uname` command.

Note: The `uname` command allows you to write the operating system's name to the standard output. The options have been specified, the strings that represent one or more system characteristics can be written to the standard output.

You don't make any changes in the default settings in `/etc/FreeBSD-update.conf`, the installation of updated kernel sources will be done along with the existing updates.



Installation of Generic Kernel is possible with FreeBSD update

The updates as distributed by the `FreeBSD-update` doesn't always include kernel. The requirement to rebuild a custom kernel isn't necessarily where the kernel sources haven't been modified after the update.

The `FreeBSD-update` command will be done using:

```
/usr/src/sys/conf/newvers.sh
```

As you can see by `-p` number reported by `uname -r`, the current patch level is obtained from this file.

Where nothing else has been changed, if you decide to rebuild a kernel, you can `uname` to report the existing patch. It is helpful to maintain multiple systems and allows for a quick check of installed updates.